

with credit and credit cards, when buying a house or a car, or when blowing a fortune on luxury goods that don't appreciate over time. But most of all, I'll guide you through all of life's stages and decision points, helping you get to a place in your twilight years where money and freedom can result in comfort and security. Are you ready to embark on this journey with me? Then let's get started.

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Here's the cold hard truth: No matter how much money you make, the world is designed to take it away. Right from the day you're born, your money is under siege. As soon as your parents put you in the cradle, the bank will encourage them to open a 529 college-savings plan to fund your future. That's probably the same bank you'll start paying fees to when you open your first checking account a few years down the line. Time passes, you grow up, and eventually, you're off to college. There's the bank again, giving you a hefty student loan. And then your first credit card. And after you graduate and get married, the bank offers you a massive mortgage. Then it scares you into buying unnecessary insurance policies. Later, it might coerce you into buying an annuity or other complicated financial products stuffed with hidden fees. Student loans, credit cards, and mortgages are powerful financial tools that are necessary if you want to live a full, well-rounded life. But you can see how easy it is for the average person who doesn't understand how these tools work, like the woman I met in Beacon Hill, to make big money mistakes. Don't let that be you. I'm here to help you avoid her fate.

It starts by waking up to the truth about your financial situation. By doing that, you'll begin using clearheaded reasoning instead of emotions when making money decisions. And that alone will change the way you relate to money.

All the time, I am asked this question: "Kevin, what is the secret to becoming wealthy?" Here it is—the secret:

Don't spend too much. Mostly save. Always invest.